

Video Transcript

Video 7: Project 1: Build a Transit Data Application (02:19)

It is now your turn. We have seen how you can request information from MBTA. We've also seen a basic front-end client that will render your locations as long as you give it to them in the right format. It is now your turn to build that middle tier, that server that is going to provide tracking for buses. Choose your database, choose your logic, figure out how you're going to do polling, and build your application. Now, this should be a lot of fun. You're bringing together a lot of the different concepts that we have seen in the course. Now once you have that under control and you're happy with it, there's a bunch of other things that you could do. These are completely optional, but I figure I would mention a few just in case you wanted to do that stretch.

When it comes to the UI, there's a bunch of improvements that you could do. For example, you could warn users when there is congestion, when buses are running slow. You could also do some improvements when it comes to the direction. You could put an arrow, say, on each of your buses as they're moving. You could warn people on the occupancy, how full the bus is. You could do that visually as well and you can see there are some other suggestions. Now you could look at it as well from the analysis perspective. When do I expect this bus to arrive, giving a certain location. You could do something similar when it comes to the times and days of the week and for example, when would be the best time to take a bus, if you could take it at mid morning.

Now you can see there a last one at the very bottom of the page, that if you captured the data of buses for 24 hours, then you could create an interesting visualization that moved through the hours of the day at an accelerated pace, to be able to get a visual sense of how traffic moves in the city. Now some of these could be quite valuable when it comes to understanding traffic patterns. So, there's a number of suggestions. These are optional once again, but these are some that might interest you and might be fun.